

Exercise 24: Chambers

Purpose:

To emphasize the importance of leadership, problem-solving, teamwork, communication.

Time Required:

15 - 30 Minutes (see variations at bottom for increased difficulty & time)

Materials & Requirements:

- 3 objects to serve as “contaminants” (can, erasers, hat, dry erase marker; anything that doesn’t lie flat on a surface will suffice)
- This exercise can be set up almost anywhere. Some space is required for cadets to move; the flight room is acceptable.

Situation (FLT/CC Info):

- The cadet leader is leading an emergency response unit. They are responding to an incident at a test laboratory in which 3 chambers in the lab have been contaminated. They are to neutralize each chamber by removing the contaminant from each chamber. Due to the contamination in each of the non-safe chambers, cadets are unable to speak to those (speaking in words) in the contaminated room. The can use “alternate” forms of communication to include, but not limited to, using sounds, foot stomping, coughing, whistling, “nonsense” words, etc. Also, the haze from the contamination nullifies all visibility; cadets in the non-safe chambers are unable to see while in the contaminated chambers. The cadets start by entering the lab in the “safe” chamber, where normal speaking communication is allowed, and all cadets can see. All contaminants must be passed from one chamber to the next, 2-3-4-1, in a clock-wise manner, toward the safe chamber, in order to be considered neutralized. This required staging one cadet in each chamber in order to pass the contaminants between them.
- In order to accomplish the objective, the team must determine alternative methods of communications for each room to guide the “blind” team members in each of the 3 contaminated chambers to the contaminants to remove them.
- The “Situation” (below) will only be read by the cadet leader, to be chosen by the FLT/CC. He/she will only be allowed 3 minutes to read the situation, though they can take notes on their own paper if they think to bring it. The cadet leader can request to reread the situation at any time during the GLP, but doing so will freeze all actions (communication and movement) of the rest of the team until the leader stops reading the situation.

Set up:

- Pick 6 (or 7 if desired) cadets to form the team, including the cadet serving as the leader. Instruct these cadets to exit the room, or stand with their backs to the space to be used for the GLP.
- The remaining cadets assist in moving all chairs (if in flight room) into the center of the room
- Place one object to serve as a contaminant in each of the chambers 2-4. Chamber 1 is the safe chamber (see diagram below)
- Assign 4 cadets to be the safety observer (SO), one for each chamber. SO’s will also call out violations.

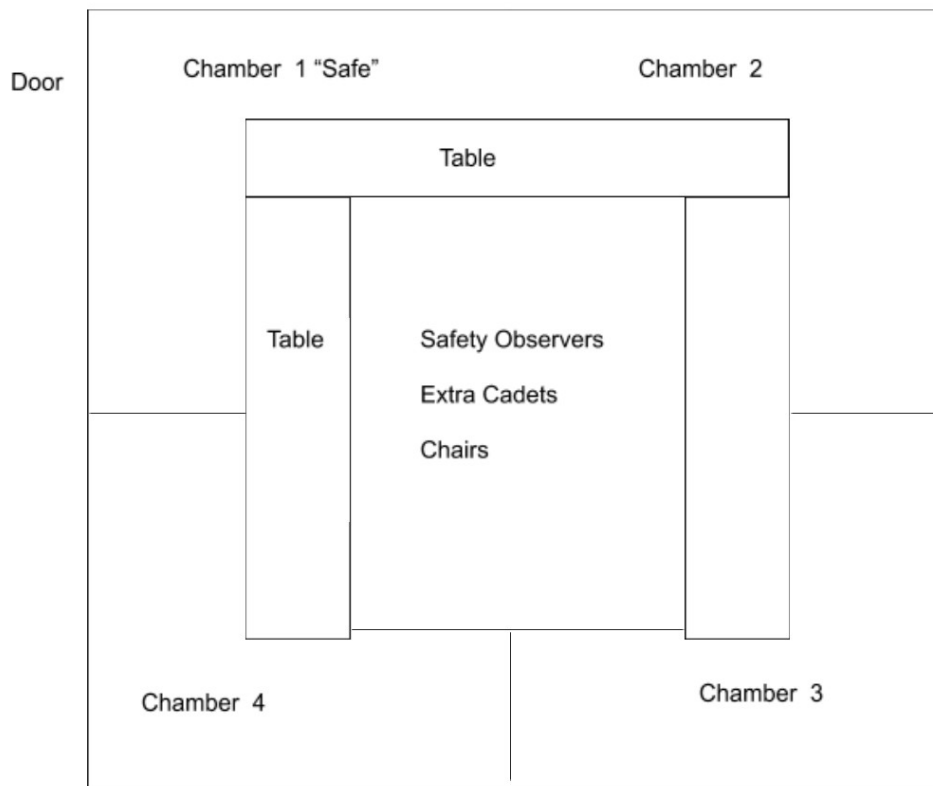
- Assign one cadet to be the time hack
- The remaining cadets are to make observations on the performance of the team
- Give the “Situation (Cadet)” to the cadet leader only; allow 3 minutes to review the information and to make any notes. Allow the leader to see the appropriate diagram for the chambers. Retrieve the Situation sheet after 3 mins has elapsed, and tell the cadet that the time hack has started and they can return to their team to work the problem.

Debrief:

Discuss the role of leadership, problem solving, followership, delegating, the importance of clear communication to all team members, teamwork.

Below are two different layouts you could set up inside.

Chamber 1 “Safe”	Chamber 2
Chamber 4	Chamber 3



Situation (To be read by the cadet leader only):

- You are the leader of an environmental emergency response team. A laboratory has experienced an incident, contaminating 3 of 4 experimental test chambers with lethal agents.
 - The only non-contaminated, “safe”, chamber is the one that your team will first enter.
- Your objective is to decontaminate the lab by removing all contaminants from each of the other chambers; each chamber contains one contaminant.
- Contaminants are safely neutralized by removing them to chamber 1.
- Each member of your team has already donned protective gear allowing you to operate safely in each of the chambers, as well as handle the contaminants with their hands.
 - However, due to the release of the contaminants filling chambers 2-4, visibility is not possible, and touching all other surfaces is lethal.
 - Also, high levels of radiation in chambers 2-4 has affected the team’s comm. equipment, resulting in dramatically reduced communication (speaking with any word (in an English dictionary) or spelling in letters is not possible).
 - However, other forms of communication into chambers 2-4 are permissible, but a different form of communication must be used for each of the chambers 2-4.
- Communication out of chambers 2-4 to chamber 1 is also not permissible.
 - Chambers 2-4 were only designed for one technician to operate in, therefore, only one member of your team can fit in each of the chambers 2-4.
- A small one-way door allows access from chamber 1 to 2, from chamber 2 to 3, 3 to 4, and 4 to 1.
- Opening the door to the next chamber requires 2 free hands, therefore all containments must first be passed to the next chamber (through the service window) before a team member can proceed into the next room.
- You have ____ minutes to complete this objective before the levels of contamination reach an unstable level and destroys the entire lab, including your team!

You will be penalized 10 seconds (no team member can work) for each of the following violations:

- Team members in chamber 2-4 not closing their eyes
- Team members touching any other obstacles in chambers 2-4 (desks, walls, chairs, etc)
- More than one members in any of the chambers 2-4
- Team members entering another chamber from the wrong direction
- Duplicating a form of communication for more than 1 chamber
- Speaking with words to any chamber 2-4
- Communication by any team member in chambers 2-4
- Dropping the containment
- attempting to enter a new chamber without first passing the containment into the next chamber
- using the wrong type of communication in a chamber

WARNING! Three repeated violations by the same member “injuries” that player; they cannot operate or be communicated to for one full minute.

Variations:

- Team Leader Swap (increased difficulty)
- Coordinate this GLP with another flight. With both flights doing this GLP at the same time, after set up, tell the cadet leader from one flight that their team are the cadets from the other flight, and vice versa.
 - The cadet team leader should enter the other flight room that does not have their original flight mates in it.
 - With no warning, the team leader must complete the GLP leading an unfamiliar team, in an unfamiliar environment.
- Reduced Chambers (easier)
 - Reduce the number of contaminated chambers to 2 if time is critical in completing the GLP. Team sizes can be reduced to 4-5, including the leader.
- Competing Teams (hard)
 - With another flight, use 2 teams to compete in trying to try to complete the objective first. Place two contaminants in each chamber, one for each team.
- Two-Way Doors (easier)
 - Allow all chambers to be accessible from both directions.
- Restricted Communication (hard)
 - Chamber 1 can only communicate with chamber 2.
 - Chamber 3 can only communicate with chamber 4.
 - Chamber 3 has full visibility of the other 3 chambers.